saying he thinks we should go back, that it is in the best interests of the global game. He tells us all independently that it is not, by any means, anything to do with the fact he'd like an IPL contract and going back would help that.

When we arrive back in Mumbai, Pietersen calls a meeting with the team in which he suddenly then admits that the IPL is in part a reason for us going back to play. Moores and Pietersen, so diametrically opposed in their methods and motives, become locked in a power struggle. Both men are quite stubborn, and by 6 January the Pietersen and Moores soap opera of unrest spills out into the media and comes to an end even quicker than many of us imagined. Both are sacked, opening a vacuum for a new beginning in English cricket.

The whole of the game feels like it's in a state of flux. A match is arranged against the West Indies, playing under the name 'Stanford Superstars'. It is arranged by the Texan billionaire Allen Stanford and approved by the ECB to try and appease the growing hunger of players to be involved in the lucrative IPL. They're offering a million pounds a player in a winner-takes-all situation. We lose the game and Stanford is discredited and eventually convicted of fraud.